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40 MIN

AI Strategy for the C-Suite

A ~40-minute strategic brief for CEOs, CIOs, CDOs and board directors. Capital discipline, talent design, governance posture, momentum past year 1. Grounded in Stanford AI Index, McKinsey, BCG/MIT, EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF.

8

CHAPTERS

40 min

DURATION

Intermediate

LEVEL

FREE

CERTIFICATE

Course Overview

For CEOs, CIOs, CDOs and board directors past basic AI literacy. Eight chapters across the C-suite AI surface: the strategic landscape (Stanford AI Index 2025 \$33.9B corporate AI investment, McKinsey 71% gen-AI adoption, Gartner <30% deliver business value, BCG/MIT leaders vs laggards 1.5–2x gap, IBM IBV 64% CEO competitive edge view, KPMG 70% top priority); the 4 AI value patterns (productivity per MIT/BCG/Harvard/Goldman 15–40%, products with Salesforce Agentforce, decisions with structured-data ML maturity, automation as the frontier); capital allocation (3 rules: concentrate · stage-gate · measure; Deloitte 25% have ROI frameworks); talent + org design (WEF 86% expect transformation, 3 talent moves, the CoE trap, hub-and-spoke + AI council); governance the regulators accept (EU AI Act Annex III + Art. 26 + Art. 50 + Art. 99 fines, US EO landscape Biden! Trump! AI Action Plan, NIST AI RMF, 4-pillar governance, Mata + Air Canada cross-domain liability); sustaining momentum past year 1 (the year-2 trap, kill 2 of every 3 pilots, scale by embedding, AI-augmented work as default, Anthropic RSP + OpenAI Preparedness vendor safety); board reporting (Tetlock calibration > confidence, 5-metric 1-page dashboard, Big-4 audit-committee questions, confidence labels); and the close — your AI strategy on one page with interactive builder, 4 trust trip-wires, through-line: capital discipline · talent design · governance posture · momentum.

FORMAT: Self-paced · 8 chapters · audio-narrated slides · interactive end-of-course builder · free certificate on completion

Who Is This For?

1

CEOs · CDOs · CIOs

2

Board directors

3

CFOs reviewing AI
capital plans

4

Strategy +
transformation leaders

Learning Outcomes

- 1 A clear-eyed view of the AI strategy landscape — Stanford AI Index, McKinsey 71% gen-AI use, the trough of disillusionment
- 2 The CEO-grade portfolio shape — 6 plays that move the P&L, 3 that disappoint, stage-gates that kill bad bets early
- 3 Capital discipline for AI investment — where the money actually returns vs where it goes to die
- 4 Talent design for the AI era — build/buy/borrow, the role architecture, the AI fluency build for the existing org
- 5 The governance posture C-suites have to defend — EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF, ISO 42001, sector overlays
- 6 Momentum past year 1 — the patterns that compound vs the patterns that decay after the first headline
- 7 4 trust trip-wires every CEO needs in writing — the boundaries you do not cross regardless of pressure

8-Chapter Curriculum

Self-paced, audio-narrated slide format. Each chapter ends with a "Monday move" the learner can apply that week.

01

The strategic landscape 2026

CHAPTER 1 · 5 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- Stanford AI Index 2025: \$33.9B corporate AI investment (GenAI \$25.2B alone).
- McKinsey: 71% regularly use gen AI.
- Gartner <30% deliver business value.
- BCG/MIT: leaders capture 1.5–2x growth + 60% better cost productivity.
- IBM CEO Study: 64% see AI as decisive.
- KPMG: 70% top priority.

02

The 4 AI value patterns

CHAPTER 2 · 5 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- Productivity (MIT/BCG/Harvard/Goldman 15–40% gains, MS Work Trend Index ~30% for active users), products (Salesforce Agentforce, MS Sales Agent — Air Canada cautionary tale), decisions (forecasting/pricing/routing, ML-on-structured-data mature), automation (back-office frontier).
- Pick 2 of 4 for next 24 months.

03

Capital allocation

CHAPTER 3 · 4 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- 3 rules: concentrate (2-3 patterns, 3-5 use cases), stage-gate (pilot/scale/embed with kill criteria), measure (Deloitte: only 25% have ROI frameworks).
- Gartner under-30% warning.
- The 80/20 of AI investment.

04

Talent and org design

CHAPTER 4 · 5 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- WEF Future of Jobs 2025: 86% expect transformation, 40% expect reduction. 3 talent moves: identify AI-native operators, upskill the senior layer, hire a small specialist team.
- The CoE trap (pure CoEs fail).
- Hub-and-spoke + AI council pattern.

05

Governance the regulators accept

CHAPTER 5 · 5 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- EU AI Act Reg. 2024/1689 (Annex III, Art. 26, Art. 50, Art. 99 fines up to 3% global turnover) in tranches through Aug 2 2026.
- US landscape Biden! Trump! AI Action Plan.
- NIST AI RMF as de facto US standard. 4-pillar governance (scope, risk, monitoring, audit).
- Cross-domain Mata + Air Canada liability.

06

Sustaining momentum past year 1

CHAPTER 6 · 4 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- The year-2 trap (pilot proliferation, no scaling). 3 fixes: kill 2 of every 3 pilots, scale 1 by embedding (not marketing), make AI-augmented work the default (perf reviews, hiring criteria, output expectations).
- Anthropic RSP + OpenAI Preparedness Framework as vendor safety landscape.

07

Board reporting

CHAPTER 7 · 5 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- Tetlock: calibration > confidence. 5 metrics on the 1-page board dashboard: investment, productivity (measured), risk register, regulatory posture, talent.
- Big-4 advisory 2024-25: audit committees increasingly require AI-use disclosure in MD&A.
- Confidence labels (strong/suggestive/vendor-claim).

08

Making it stick: your AI strategy on one page

CHAPTER 8 · 4 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- 4 pieces: 2 value patterns
- capital envelope
- AI council
- governance posture. 4 trust trip-wires: no untested model in regulated decisions, no vendor lock without exit clause, no AI-generated board content unverified (Mata principle), no "set and forget". Interactive one-pager builder.